FREE CHEAT SHEET · FOR PAKISTANI STUDENTS AT UC DAVIS

Study smarter with Claude: a beginner's guide on the free plan

No tech background needed and no subscription. Follow the steps below in order and you can save 5 or more hours every week on readings, assignments, emails and planning.

✓ Works on the free plan | ✓ Phone or laptop | ✓ English, Urdu or Roman Urdu

Part 1: Set up Claude in 5 minutes

1. **Open Claude.** On a laptop, go to **claude.ai**. On a phone, install the free **Claude** app (made by Anthropic) from the App Store or Google Play.
2. **Sign up for free.** Tap "Continue with Google" or enter your email. Skip any paid-plan screen, because the free plan is all you need for this guide.
3. **Find the message box.** It sits at the bottom of the screen. Type there just as you would in WhatsApp, then press Enter or tap the arrow.
4. **Find the "+" or 📎 button.** It lets you attach a PDF, a screenshot or a photo of your notes, and Claude can read all of these.
5. **Phone tip:** tap the 🎤 microphone on your keyboard and just *talk* to type your question. This is great when you're tired or walking to class.
6. **Say hi to test it.** Paste this message as your first one:

> `I'm a first-year student at UC Davis from Pakistan, majoring in Computer Science. I'm new to AI tools. In 5 short bullet points, tell me the most useful ways you can help me this quarter.`

💡 The one rule to remember

Treat Claude like a **smart senior student or a TA** sitting next to you, not like Google. Talk to it in full sentences, give it background and ask follow-up questions. If an answer isn't right, reply "make it simpler" or "shorter" or "give an example". You don't need to start over.

🗣️ Urdu is fine too

Claude understands Urdu and Roman Urdu. Try: *"Mujhe recursion bilkul samajh nahi aaya, Urdu mein simple example ke saath samjhao."* You can also ask it to explain something in Urdu first and then in English.

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PART 2

The CHAI formula ☕ for great answers every time

Most beginners type 4 words and get a generic answer. To get an answer that fits *you*, include these 4 things in your message:

C

Context

Who are you? Which class, what level?

H

Help needed

What exactly do you want done?

A

Add details

Deadline, word count, your notes, rubric

I

Ideal format

Bullets? Table? Quiz? 5 lines max?

WEAK PROMPT

```
explain supply and demand
```

This gets a textbook-style answer that is long, generic and hard to revise from.

CHAI PROMPT

```
C: I'm a first-year in ECN 1A at UC Davis.
H: Explain supply and demand so I can answer
midterm questions.
A: My midterm is in 4 days. Use examples about
chai, rent in Davis or gas prices.
I: 5 bullet points, then 3 practice questions
with answers hidden at the bottom.
```

Part 3: The magic follow-ups

The first answer is only a draft. These short replies make it better:

TYPE THIS...	...WHEN
`Explain like I'm 12.`	The answer is too technical
`Give me a real-life example.`	You understand the words but not the idea
`Quiz me one question at a time.`	You want to check whether you've actually learned it
`What did I get wrong, and why?`	After you answer its quiz questions
`Make it shorter. Max 5 lines.`	The answer is too long
`Ask me 3 questions first before you answer.`	You aren't sure what to include and want Claude to interview you
`Are you sure? Double-check that.`	Anything involving facts, numbers, dates or citations

⚠️ Claude can be wrong

AI sometimes states wrong facts confidently, and it can even make up sources. **Always verify** deadlines, formulas, citations, visa rules and anything important against your syllabus, Canvas, your professor or official UC Davis offices.

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PART 4

12 copy-paste prompts that save hours

Copy a prompt, replace the yellow parts with your own details, and send it.

01 Understand a confusing lecture

```
📎 [attach slides or a photo of notes]
I didn't understand this lecture on topic.
Explain the 3 most important ideas simply, with
one example each. Then tell me what's most
likely to be on the exam.
```

02 Turn notes into a quiz

```
📎 [attach notes]
Make 10 practice questions from these notes: 5
multiple-choice and 5 short-answer. Ask me one
at a time and wait for my answer before giving
feedback.
```

03 Read a long PDF in 10 minutes

```
📎 [attach reading]
Summarize this reading for class: the main
argument, 3 key points with page numbers, and 2
questions I could raise in discussion section.
```

04 Plan the 10-week quarter

```
📎 [attach syllabi]
Here are my syllabi. List every exam and
deadline by week (1–10 plus finals). Warn me
about weeks where several things are due at
once.
```

05 Get essay feedback (not a ghostwriter)

```
📎 [attach your draft + rubric]
Don't rewrite this. Act as a strict grader using
this rubric. Give me a score, my 3 biggest
weaknesses and questions that help me fix them
myself.
```

06 Email a professor

```
Help me write a short, polite email to Professor
name. I missed a quiz because I was sick and
want to ask about options. Respectful American
academic tone, not overly formal, under 120
words.
```

07 Prepare for office hours

```
I'm going to office hours for class. I'm stuck
on problem. Help me write 3 clear, specific
questions so I don't waste the professor's time.
```

08 Understand code errors

```
I'm learning Python. Here is my code and the
error message. Don't just fix it. Explain what
the error means, give me a hint, and let me try
again.
[paste code + error]
```

09 Improve a resume line

```
Rewrite this resume bullet for a US internship
application. Use a strong action verb and add a
number if possible. Give 3 options:
"I helped in my uncle's shop in Lahore"
```

10 Practice an interview

```
Act as an interviewer for a software intern
role. Ask me one behavioral question at a time.
After each of my answers, score it out of 10 and
show me how to improve it using the STAR method.
```

11 Plan your week around everything

```
Make a weekly schedule table for me. Classes:
list. Campus job: hours. Include the 5 daily
prayers, Jumu'ah on Friday, meals, the gym and 2
study blocks a day. I study best in the
morning.
```

12 Explain American "adulting"

```
I'm a new international student from Pakistan.
Explain what a credit score is / how a lease
works / how US tipping works in simple words,
with mistakes newcomers usually make.
```


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PART 5

Get the most out of the free plan

The free plan has a message limit that resets every few hours. These habits help you stay under it:

1. Put everything in one message

Send one detailed CHAI prompt rather than 6 tiny messages, which use up your limit quickly.

2. Start a new chat for each new topic

Long chats use more of your limit. When you switch subjects, click **"New chat"**.

3. Upload only the pages you need

Attach chapter 4, not the full 300-page textbook. Screenshots of the key pages work too.

4. Copy great answers somewhere safe

Paste useful answers into Google Docs or Notes so you don't have to ask again.

5. Work during off-peak hours

If you hit the limit, the app tells you when it resets. Plan your heavy study with Claude around that time.

6. Ask for a summary before moving on

Before you leave a long chat, type: *"Summarize everything we figured out in 10 bullets."* Paste that into a new chat to continue.

🛑 Academic integrity: please read this

- **Every class has its own AI policy.** Check the syllabus, or ask the professor: "Is using AI for *brainstorming / feedback / studying* allowed?"
- Submitting AI-written work as your own when it isn't allowed can be treated as **academic misconduct**. For international students, that can put more than your grade at risk.
- The safe and smart way: use Claude to **explain, quiz, plan and give feedback**. You do the actual writing and problem-solving yourself.
- Never paste other people's private information, exam questions you were told not to share, or passwords into any AI tool.

Your 7-day Claude challenge

☐	**Day 1**	Sign up and send the "Say hi" prompt from page 1.
☐	**Day 2**	Upload one lecture's slides and use prompt **01**.
☐	**Day 3**	Turn your notes into a quiz with prompt **02**, and answer every question.
☐	**Day 4**	Upload all your syllabi and build your quarter plan with prompt **04**.
☐	**Day 5**	Make your weekly schedule with prompt **11** and stick it on your wall.
☐	**Day 6**	Improve 3 resume bullets with prompt **09**.
☐	**Day 7**	Look back on the week: how many hours did you save? Share this cheat sheet with one friend 🤝



Want the full Playbook?

This sheet has 12 prompts. The **Claude Playbook for Pakistani Students** has **100+ prompts**, a 10-week quarter planner, an internship and OPT-season toolkit, a Ramadan study plan and money templates. Look for the link in your email.

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